ACT 1 / HAND TO EVERY PLAYER

The case brief

What happened

At The Copper Fig, six pear-and-honey tarts were plated at 8:10 p.m. Chef Dev placed them on the service trolley at 8:12. At 8:18, the trolley was empty. The dining guests never received their final course. No person was hurt.

Your task

Identify who removed the six desserts, the route and destination, and the most likely reason. Build an evidence chain; do not vote from one clue alone. Everyone may read their own witness sheet aloud and show it to others.

People to consider

Mira Rowan (manager), Dev Patel (pastry chef), Lana Price (server), and an unknown private-order customer. A witness may be mistaken. A card or booking name can be borrowed. Ask what each fact proves and what it leaves open.

TIMELINE TO FILL

8:10 plated • 8:12 on trolley • 8:18 missing. Add the events you learn from the witness sheets below.

RESTAURANT LAYOUT / NOT TO SCALE



Front door serves guests. Rear corridor connects kitchen, cold room and rear pickup door.

Nora Vale

A / Pastry station

Your statement

You helped plate six identical pear-and-honey tarts at 8:10 p.m. Chef Dev stayed beside the hot oven while you cleaned the pastry bench. From 8:13 to 8:17 you could see Dev through the open kitchen pass. He did not leave the pastry station.

Your private observation

You found a tiny blue thread caught on the service trolley wheel after the alarm. Its weave looks like the blue linen used to cover the small stock cart, not the white napkins on guest tables.

Conversation prompt

Tell the group which worker you could continuously see. Show the blue-thread note to anyone comparing routes.

SHARE IT

Read your evidence to the group in your own words. You may show this page. No clue should remain secret at the final vote.